

Core Management Skills for Teachers

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Core Management Skills for Teachers

1. INTRODUCTION

A teacher does many jobs every day. The teacher plans lessons, controls the class, checks work and meets parents. All these jobs need management. So every teacher is the manager of his or her own classroom. The abilities that help a teacher do this well are called management skills.

2. MEANING OF MANAGEMENT SKILLS

Management means getting work done in an organized way by using people, time and things well. Management skills are the abilities that help a teacher plan, organize, guide and check work in the classroom. Nobody is born with these skills. A teacher learns them with training and practice.

3. IMPORTANCE OF MANAGEMENT SKILLS

Management skills help a teacher to:

- save time for teaching
- keep discipline in the class
- complete the syllabus on time
- build good relations with students and parents
- reduce stress

4. THEORIES OF MANAGEMENT SKILLS

Fayol's Theory (1949)

Henri Fayol gave five functions of management: planning, organizing, commanding, coordinating and controlling. A teacher uses all five in the classroom every day.

Katz's Three Skills (1955)

Robert Katz said a manager needs three skills: technical skill (knowing the work), human skill (working with people) and conceptual skill (seeing the whole picture). A teacher needs all three.

Kounin's Theory (1970)

Jacob Kounin said a good teacher stops problems before they grow. He called this “withitness”, which means the teacher knows what is happening in every part of the class.

5. CORE MANAGEMENT SKILLS FOR TEACHERS

5.1 Planning Skill

Planning means deciding before the work what to do, how to do it and when. A teacher makes lesson plans and divides the syllabus into weeks. Good planning saves time and the syllabus is completed on time.

5.2 Organizing Skill

Organizing means arranging people and things. The teacher makes a seating plan, makes groups and gives duties like class monitor. Charts, books and other things are kept in a fixed place.

5.3 Classroom Management Skill

This skill means keeping the class calm and ready to learn. The teacher makes a few clear rules and follows them every day. The teacher uses eye contact and a calm voice instead of shouting.

5.4 Time Management Skill

A period is only 35 to 40 minutes. The teacher starts on time and divides the period into parts: review, teaching, practice and homework. In this way no minute is wasted.

5.5 Communication Skill

Communication means sharing ideas clearly. The teacher uses simple words, a clear voice and good body language. The teacher also listens carefully to students and parents.

5.6 Leadership Skill

The teacher is the leader of the class. A good teacher leads by example, for example by coming on time and speaking politely. Students copy what they see.

5.7 Decision-Making Skill

A teacher makes many decisions every day. A good teacher first collects the facts, thinks about the choices and then takes a fair decision. A decision should never be taken in anger.

5.8 Motivation Skill

Motivation means creating a wish to learn. The teacher praises effort, gives small rewards and uses interesting activities. A motivated student learns faster and behaves better.

Table 1 gives a short summary of these skills.

Table 1: Summary of Core Management Skills

Skill	Meaning	Example
Planning	Deciding before the work	Lesson plan
Organizing	Arranging people and things	Seating plan, groups
Classroom Management	Keeping the class calm	Clear rules
Time Management	Using every minute well	Dividing the period
Communication	Sharing ideas clearly	Simple words, listening
Leadership	Leading by example	Coming on time
Decision-Making	Choosing the best option	Fair decision, not in anger
Motivation	Creating a wish to learn	Praise and rewards

6. PROBLEMS TEACHERS FACE

- Large classes
- Lack of resources
- Extra non-teaching duties
- Little training in management
- Heavy syllabus and exam pressure

7. HOW TO IMPROVE MANAGEMENT SKILLS

- Attend training and workshops
- Learn from senior teachers
- Think after each class about what went well and what to change
- Make clear rules and routines
- Use a daily planner and timetable

8. CONCLUSION

A teacher is the manager of the classroom. Skills like planning, organizing, classroom management, time management, communication, leadership, decision-making and motivation help the teacher do this job well. These skills can be learned through training and practice. When a teacher manages well, students learn better and the school runs smoothly.

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